MZUZU UNIVERSITY

FACULTY OF HUMANITIES AND SOCIAL SCIENCES

DEPARTMENT OF COMMUNICATION STUDIES

END OF SEMESTER EXAMINATION

COMM 1101: COMMUNICATION SKILLS I

DATE: 25 MARCH 2019 **TIME: 2 HRS 30 MINUTES**

INSTRUCTION: Answer all Questions

Question 1

Read the following passage and summarise it note-form.

Many people underestimate the importance of building and maintaining goodwill when they write letters to customers and clients. Business letters written to people outside your organization should do two things: keep the reader's needs in mind, and present a favourable image of the organization.

For each business letter you write, think of the overall effect your writing will have on the reader. The letter should create an impression of a friendly organization that cares about its customers and clients. Also, the letter should express genuine interest in the reader. You can convey goodwill in your letters by anticipating questions the reader might have, such as describing the warranty offered with a product. Another way to promote goodwill is to include information that will interest the reader. For example, you might enclose with the letter an article, a brochure, or a catalogue that provides more detailed information.

Letters influence what people think about an organization. What you say and how you say it influences how the reader will react to the message. Even if you are writing a letter that answers no to a customer's request, you should use positive wording and the you-attitude. In this way you help to create a favourable view of your organization.

(10 marks)

Question 2

Read the following article and answer the questions that follow

Managing diversity is an important issue for businesses. To attract and retain qualified employees and to work with customers around the world, businesses need to address the interests and needs of diverse groups. Managing diversity includes recognising and understanding differences in gender, culture, ethnic background, age, and physical ability.

To attract and retain a diverse workforce, businesses must recognize and accommodate differences in employees' lifestyles and culture. For example, the increase in the number of women and ethnic minorities in the workforce has led businesses to offer a variety of options to employees. Offering flexible work schedules, providing assistance with child and parent care, and presenting cultural awareness courses are some ways businesses address diversity in the workforce.

Managing diversity also extends to attracting and retaining customers. In the age of the Internet and electronic mail, businesses come in contact with people of different cultural and ethnic backgrounds every day. To compete on global basis, businesses must develop an understanding of, and respect for, cultural differences. This awareness involves learning and accommodating the business customs and cultural beliefs of customers in other countries.

a. What is the main idea of the article? **(2 marks)**
b. What are the two reasons for managing diversity in the workplace? **(2 marks)**
c. Briefly explain what is involved in managing diversity according to the passage. **(2 marks)**
d. Give two examples to illustrate how businesses manage diversity in the workforce according to the article. **(2 marks)**
e. How can businesses increase their understanding of, and respect for, cultural differences? **(2 marks)**

Question 3

Break the following excerpt from a passage into four effective paragraphs. At the point marked (T), insert an appropriate transitional word or phrase.

In August, one of our supervisors, Troy Chimangeni, suggested that we investigate ways to reduce the paperwork overload in our division. **(T)** we asked Troy and his two assistants to analyse the procedures in their department and to submit some

recommendations for reducing some unnecessary paperwork. Not surprisingly, they found that we now make and distribute far too many copies of routine forms. **(T)** we now distribute 23 copies of purchase orders throughout the company. **(T)** they found that 16 of the employees who received these purchase orders simply file the copies for future use. **(T)** Troy and his co-workers found that other routine forms are copies that are distributed unnecessarily. **(T)** copies of budget estimates for each project are sent to every manager in the division. **(T)** copies should be sent only to members of the project team, their supervisors, and the division vice president. When Troy and his two assistants complete their report, we will share their findings with you. **(T)** if you should have any suggestions for reducing our paper overload, please let us know.

(11 marks)

Question 4

a. Your university campus has been having difficulty with motorists driving too fast. The posted speed limit is 40 kilometres an hour; however, you have observed that some motorists have been driving up to 80 kilometres per hour. Although no serious accidents have occurred to date, people walking and students riding bicycles have almost be struck by speeding traffic. You are aware of the success experienced in some similar university campuses with the addition of speed barriers.

   Write a report to the University Registrar (UR) on the findings from your investigation into this issue. Provide the UR with possible recommendations.

   (15 marks)

b. Rewrite the sentences below to eliminate the use of personal and subjective references

   i. I feel that the staff members should receive further training in all aspects of communication. **(1 mark)**

   ii. In our opinion the bank should be open until 1 p. m. every weekday evening and on Saturday mornings for the convenience of customers. **(1 mark)**

   iii. I think the members of the senior class will agree that instruction is needed on completion of job search documents.

   (1 mark)

iv. In my opinion, the use of spreadsheets will make it easier to compile our monthly sales report. **(1 mark)**

v. It seems that the organized floor plan is proving effective.

(1 mark)

Question 5

Present the bibliographical entries below in APA style

R. Shuter. (2012). 298 – 305. A field of study of nonverbal communication in Africa. Communication Monographs. 44. **(3 marks)**

J. Buckley, and D. Gates. (2012). Put it in writing (edition 2). Prentice Hall: New York. **(3 marks)**

P. Kachinziri. 22 March, 2019. Daily Times. Award bittersweet for hockey women. p. 6. **(3 marks)**